

Chief Executive Officer -- Position Description

MANDATE CONTEXT

This is a new role: the family-owned group is professionalising its governance ahead of a planned minority stake sale, and is appointing its first outside Chief Executive Officer. Internal context: the founder will remain as Executive Chairman and will keep a close involvement in strategy for at least the first year. This dynamic should be handled sensitively with candidates.

IDEAL PROFILE

The ideal candidate has run a multi-business-line group of comparable size, has worked successfully alongside a founder or controlling shareholder, and has a track record of professionalising an organisation without losing its entrepreneurial culture.

REPORTING STRUCTURE

The role reports to the Board of Directors, with a close working relationship with the Executive Chairman. The CEO will have seven direct reports across the group's business units, with a total organisation of around six hundred people. The role is based in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia.

EMPLOYMENT AND PACKAGE

This is a full-time, permanent position, with a target start date of 1 January 2027. The base salary range is SAR 900,000 to SAR 1,150,000 per month. The notice period required is six months. Bonus target is 50 percent of base salary. LTIP: a carried interest style long-term incentive tied to the planned stake sale.

Benefits and allowances include a housing allowance, a driver and vehicle allowance, and private schooling for dependants.

CANDIDATE REQUIREMENTS

Required: prior experience as CEO or deputy CEO of a group with multiple business lines.

Required: demonstrated experience working with a founder-led or family-controlled board.

Preferred: experience preparing a business for external investment or a stake sale.

Preferred: existing relationships with regional institutional investors.

COMPETENCY WEIGHTING

Technically, strategic planning and portfolio management across business units should carry the most weight, followed by capital allocation and investment discipline, with governance and board-readiness experience weighted a little lower.

Behaviourally, stakeholder influence and the ability to build trust with a founder should be weighted most heavily, with change leadership and resilience under ambiguity close behind, and team building weighted somewhat lower.